

Simtec Consult - Firewall Management Policy

Version: 1.1

Status: Approved

Owner: Director

Applies to: All staff

Related to: Cyber Essentials

Last reviewed: 2026-06-22

Next review due: 2026-09-22

Purpose

Firewalls reduce unnecessary exposure of devices, servers, and cloud-hosted services to the internet.

Policy

Simtec does not operate an office network or organisation-owned routers. In scope are device software firewalls, AWS Lightsail firewalls, Cloudflare controls, and host firewall rules where used.

Staff devices must keep the operating system software firewall enabled where available. Firewall settings must be protected by local account passwords and a separate local administrator account where administrator rights are needed. Custom rules or app exceptions may only be added for a business need and with Director approval.

AWS, Cloudflare, and server firewall changes must be made by authorised administrators only. Rules must be limited to required services and removed when no longer needed.

Public web applications may allow HTTP and HTTPS. SSH must use key-based access. Database access must be restricted to known IP addresses where exposed.

Firewall administration must not be exposed directly to the internet. Cloud firewall administration must use named accounts protected with MFA.

Review

Firewall rules are reviewed at least annually and when services change. The review checks open ports, source restrictions, admin protection, and old rules.

Review History

Date	Reviewer	Description	Next review due
2026-06-22	Policy Manager	Clarified local administrator protection for BYOD firewall settings.	2026-09-22
2026-06-03	Policy Manager	Created current policy document aligned to Simtec requirements and relevant Cyber Essentials answers.	2026-09-03